

Example : Public Library Book Reservation

As-is

- Customer visits the library and asks the librarian whether a particular book is available (~ 10 min)
- If the book is unavailable, the customer writes their name and contact details in a reservation register (~ 1 min)
- Librarian manually checks the register when the book is returned
- Customer is contacted by phone and asked to collect the book (this and above process take ~ 10 min)

Gaps

- Customer must physically visit the library
- Maintain paper register that is time consuming
- No reservation status for customer
- Manually monitor status by librarian
- Phone calls are needed to notify customer

To-be

- Customer searches for the book through the library app (~ 2 min)
- With a click customer can reserve a book and submit the details (~ 1 min)
- System will automatically add the customer to the reservation queue
- When book is available, the system automatically sends a notification (this and above process take ~ 2 min)

Problem Statement

Library customers currently spend approximately 11 minutes visiting the library and completing a reservation for an unavailable book, while library staff spend approximately 5 hours per week processing around 30 reservations through paper records and manual notifications. This results in additional effort for both customers and staff, increased processing time, and limited visibility into reservation status due to the manual reservation process.